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50 RECIPES + 3 BAKING LESSONS

Cookies, Brownies & Dessert Bars

50 Recipes for Drop Cookies, Fudgy Brownies, Blondies, and Layered Bars

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Cookies, Brownies & Dessert Bars

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This book is sold for personal use. Recipes are provided for home baking; please check your own equipment, ingredient brands, and altitude, as results can vary. These recipes are based on standard baking ratios, not on documented testing of every recipe in this book. Chill times given for doughs are minimums — doughs can be chilled longer without harm.

Always check ingredient labels for allergens before serving to guests.

Contents

PART 1	Fundamentals	4
PART 2	Cookies	6
PART 3	Brownies	28
PART 4	Blondies & Dessert Bars	41
	Index	56

PART 1

Fundamentals

Three lessons on cookie dough handling, what actually separates fudgy from cakey brownies, and building layered bars that cut cleanly.

Cookie Dough Basics: Chilling, Scooping, and Spacing

Most cookie doughs benefit from chilling for at least 30 minutes before baking. Chilled dough spreads less in the oven, giving a thicker cookie with a more defined edge, and it also lets the flour fully hydrate, which improves texture.

A spring-loaded cookie scoop gives you evenly sized cookies that bake at the same rate, so none finish early and burn while others are still underbaked. A level 1.5-tablespoon scoop is the standard size used throughout this book unless a recipe says otherwise.

Space cookies at least 2 inches apart on the tray — most doughs spread more than you expect, and crowded cookies bake into each other with uneven edges.

- Chill dough at least 30 minutes for thicker, better-defined cookies
- A 1.5-tbsp scoop keeps cookies evenly sized and evenly baked
- Space cookies at least 2 inches apart to prevent spreading into each other
- Rotate the tray halfway through baking if your oven bakes unevenly

Fudgy vs. Cakey Brownies: What Actually Changes the Texture

Fudgy brownies use a higher ratio of fat and chocolate to flour, and often skip leavening (baking powder) entirely. Cakey brownies use more flour relative to fat, plus a small amount of baking powder, which lightens the crumb into something closer to a dense cake.

The number of eggs also matters: more eggs, and especially more egg yolks, add richness and a denser, fudgier texture. More whipped or beaten whole eggs add air and lift, moving a brownie toward cakey.

Bake time matters too — a slightly underbaked brownie (moist crumbs on a toothpick, not wet batter) will always read fudgier than the same batter baked a few minutes longer.

- More fat and chocolate, less flour, no baking powder → fudgy
- More flour, a little baking powder, more whipped egg → cakey
- More egg yolks richness and fudge; more whole beaten egg adds lift
- A slightly shorter bake time makes almost any brownie fudgier

Building Layered Bars: Crusts, Fillings, and Clean Cuts

Most bar recipes start with a pressed crust — baked briefly on its own before the filling goes on, so it holds together instead of turning soggy under a wet layer.

Line the pan with parchment paper, leaving an overhang on two sides, so the entire slab lifts out cleanly for cutting on a board, rather than trying to cut bars inside the pan and scratching it up.

Chill bars fully before cutting, especially anything with a cream cheese, caramel, or ganache layer — cutting warm bars drags the filling and gives ragged edges. A long, sharp knife wiped clean between cuts gives the cleanest lines.

- Pre-bake the crust briefly before adding a wet filling
- Line the pan with parchment, overhanging two sides, for clean removal
- Chill fully before cutting for neat, non-dragging slices
- Wipe the knife clean between cuts for sharp, even edges

PART 2

Cookies

Twenty-two cookies, from the essential chocolate chip through rolled, sandwiched, iced, and piped varieties.

Classic Chocolate Chip Cookies

The benchmark cookie this book's other drop cookies build on — crisp edges, chewy center.

PREP 15 MIN, PLUS 30 MIN CHILLING • BAKE 10-12 MIN • BAKING SHEET • 350F/175C • 24 COOKIES

- 2 1/4 cups (280g) all-purpose flour
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1 tsp salt
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 3/4 cup (150g) granulated sugar
- 3/4 cup (165g) packed brown sugar
- 2 large eggs
- 2 tsp vanilla extract
- 2 cups (340g) semisweet chocolate chips

METHOD

1. Whisk the flour, baking soda, and salt together.
2. Beat the butter and both sugars until fluffy, add the eggs one at a time, then the vanilla.
3. Mix in the flour mixture just until combined, then fold in the chocolate chips.
4. Chill the dough at least 30 minutes.
5. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Scoop 1.5-tbsp mounds onto a lined baking sheet, spaced 2 inches apart.
6. Bake 10-12 minutes, until the edges are golden but the centers still look slightly underdone.

7. Cool on the tray 5 minutes before transferring to a rack.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 5 days, or freeze dough balls up to 3 months.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

Classic Sugar Cookies

A simple rolled or scooped cookie, good plain or topped with a quick glaze.

PREP 15 MIN, PLUS 1 HOUR CHILLING • BAKE 8-10 MIN • BAKING SHEET • 350F/175C • 24 COOKIES

- 3 cups (375g) all-purpose flour
- 1 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 1 1/2 cups (300g) granulated sugar
- 2 large eggs
- 1 tbsp vanilla extract

METHOD

1. Whisk the flour, baking powder, and salt together.
2. Beat the butter and sugar until fluffy, add the eggs one at a time, then the vanilla.
3. Mix in the flour mixture until a soft dough forms.
4. Chill at least 1 hour. Heat the oven to 350F/175C.
5. Scoop 1.5-tbsp mounds onto a lined sheet and flatten slightly with your palm.
6. Bake 8-10 minutes, until the edges just turn golden.
7. Cool on the tray 5 minutes before transferring to a rack.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 1 week.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

Classic Peanut Butter Cookies

Dense and tender, with the classic criss-cross fork pattern.

PREP 15 MIN • BAKE 10-12 MIN • BAKING SHEET • 350F/175C • 22 COOKIES

- 1 1/4 cups (155g) all-purpose flour
- 1/2 tsp baking soda
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 cup (260g) creamy peanut butter
- 1/2 cup (113g) unsalted butter, softened
- 1/2 cup (100g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (110g) packed brown sugar
- 1 large egg
- 1 tsp vanilla extract

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Whisk the flour, baking soda, and salt together.
2. Beat the peanut butter, butter, and both sugars until fluffy, add the egg and vanilla.
3. Mix in the flour mixture just until combined.
4. Scoop 1.5-tbsp balls onto a lined sheet, spaced 2 inches apart, and flatten with a fork in a criss-cross pattern.
5. Bake 10-12 minutes, until the edges are set.
6. Cool on the tray 5 minutes before transferring to a rack.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 1 week.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, dairy, and peanuts.

Classic Oatmeal Raisin Cookies

Chewy, spiced, and studded with plump raisins.

PREP 15 MIN • BAKE 11-13 MIN • BAKING SHEET • 350F/175C • 24 COOKIES

- 1 1/2 cups (190g) all-purpose flour
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1 tsp ground cinnamon
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 1 cup (220g) packed brown sugar
- 1/2 cup (100g) granulated sugar
- 2 large eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 3 cups (270g) old-fashioned rolled oats
- 1 cup (150g) raisins

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Whisk the flour, baking soda, cinnamon, and salt together.
2. Beat the butter and both sugars until fluffy, add the eggs one at a time, then the vanilla.
3. Mix in the flour mixture, then fold in the oats and raisins.
4. Scoop 1.5-tbsp mounds onto a lined sheet, spaced 2 inches apart.
5. Bake 11-13 minutes, until the edges are golden.
6. Cool on the tray 5 minutes before transferring to a rack.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 1 week.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

Oatmeal Chocolate Chip Cookies

The oatmeal cookie base swapped to chocolate chips instead of raisins.

PREP 15 MIN • BAKE 11-13 MIN • BAKING SHEET • 350F/175C • 24 COOKIES

- 1 1/2 cups (190g) all-purpose flour
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1/2 tsp ground cinnamon
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 1 cup (220g) packed brown sugar
- 1/2 cup (100g) granulated sugar
- 2 large eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 3 cups (270g) old-fashioned rolled oats
- 1 1/2 cups (255g) semisweet chocolate chips

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Whisk the flour, baking soda, cinnamon, and salt together.
2. Beat the butter and both sugars until fluffy, add the eggs one at a time, then the vanilla.
3. Mix in the flour mixture, then fold in the oats and chocolate chips.
4. Scoop 1.5-tbsp mounds onto a lined sheet, spaced 2 inches apart.
5. Bake 11-13 minutes, until the edges are golden.
6. Cool on the tray 5 minutes before transferring to a rack.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 1 week.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

Classic Snickerdoodles

Soft, tangy from cream of tartar, rolled in cinnamon sugar before baking.

PREP 15 MIN, PLUS 30 MIN CHILLING • BAKE 9-11 MIN • BAKING SHEET • 375F/190C • 24 COOKIES

DOUGH

- 2 3/4 cups (345g) all-purpose flour
- 2 tsp cream of tartar
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 1 1/2 cups (300g) granulated sugar
- 2 large eggs

COATING

- 1/4 cup (50g) granulated sugar
- 2 tsp ground cinnamon

METHOD

1. Whisk the flour, cream of tartar, baking soda, and salt together.
2. Beat the butter and sugar until fluffy, add the eggs one at a time.
3. Mix in the flour mixture until a soft dough forms. Chill 30 minutes.
4. Heat the oven to 375F/190C. Mix the cinnamon-sugar coating in a small bowl.
5. Roll 1.5-tbsp balls of dough in the coating, then place on a lined sheet, spaced 2 inches apart.
6. Bake 9-11 minutes, until puffed and just set.
7. Cool on the tray 5 minutes before transferring to a rack.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 1 week.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

Classic Shortbread Cookies

A three-ingredient-base cookie, buttery and crumbly, good plain or dipped in chocolate.

PREP 15 MIN, PLUS 30 MIN CHILLING • BAKE 16-18 MIN • BAKING SHEET • 325F/160C • 20 COOKIES

- 2 cups (250g) all-purpose flour
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 2/3 cup (80g) powdered sugar
- 1 tsp vanilla extract

METHOD

1. Beat the butter, powdered sugar, and vanilla until smooth, not fluffy.
2. Mix in the flour and salt just until a dough forms.
3. Shape into a log, wrap, and chill 30 minutes.
4. Heat the oven to 325F/160C. Slice the log into 1/2-inch rounds and place on a lined sheet.
5. Bake 16-18 minutes, until the edges are just barely golden.
6. Cool completely on the tray before moving, since shortbread is fragile while warm.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 2 weeks.

Allergens: Contains wheat and dairy.

Classic Molasses Cookies

Spiced and chewy, with crackled tops from rolling in sugar before baking.

PREP 15 MIN, PLUS 1 HOUR CHILLING • BAKE 10-12 MIN • BAKING SHEET • 350F/175C • 24 COOKIES

- 2 1/4 cups (280g) all-purpose flour
- 2 tsp baking soda
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 1/2 tsp ground ginger
- 1 tsp ground cinnamon
- 1/4 tsp ground cloves
- 3/4 cup (170g) unsalted butter, softened
- 1 cup (200g) granulated sugar, plus more for rolling
- 1/4 cup (85g) molasses
- 1 large egg

METHOD

1. Whisk the flour, baking soda, salt, and spices together.
2. Beat the butter and sugar until fluffy, add the molasses and egg.
3. Mix in the flour mixture until combined. Chill at least 1 hour.
4. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Roll 1.5-tbsp balls in granulated sugar and place on a lined sheet, spaced 2 inches apart.
5. Bake 10-12 minutes, until the tops crackle.
6. Cool on the tray 5 minutes before transferring to a rack.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 1 week.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

Classic Gingerbread Cookies

A rolled, cut-out cookie firm enough to hold its shape and decorate with icing.

PREP 20 MIN, PLUS 1 HOUR CHILLING • BAKE 9-11 MIN • BAKING SHEET • 350F/175C • 20 COOKIES

- 3 cups (375g) all-purpose flour
- 1 tbsp ground ginger
- 2 tsp ground cinnamon
- 1/2 tsp ground cloves
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup (170g) unsalted butter, softened
- 3/4 cup (165g) packed brown sugar
- 1/2 cup (170g) molasses
- 1 large egg

METHOD

1. Whisk the flour, spices, baking soda, and salt together.
2. Beat the butter and brown sugar until fluffy, add the molasses and egg.
3. Mix in the flour mixture until a firm dough forms. Chill at least 1 hour.
4. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Roll the dough 1/4-inch thick and cut into shapes.
5. Place on a lined sheet and bake 9-11 minutes, until just set at the edges.
6. Cool completely before decorating with royal icing (see Decorating Handbook).

Storage: Store undecorated cookies airtight up to 2 weeks.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

Classic Chocolate Crinkle Cookies

A fudgy chocolate cookie rolled in powdered sugar, which cracks into a crinkled pattern as it bakes.

PREP 20 MIN, PLUS 2 HOURS CHILLING • BAKE 10-12 MIN • BAKING SHEET • 350F/175C • 24 COOKIES

- 1 cup (125g) all-purpose flour
- 1/2 cup (45g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 1 tsp baking powder
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1/2 cup (120ml) vegetable oil
- 1 cup (200g) granulated sugar
- 2 large eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1/2 cup (60g) powdered sugar, for rolling

METHOD

1. Whisk the flour, cocoa, baking powder, and salt together.
2. Whisk the oil, granulated sugar, eggs, and vanilla together, then stir in the flour mixture to form a soft, sticky dough.
3. Chill at least 2 hours, until firm enough to roll.
4. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Roll 1.5-tbsp balls of dough in powdered sugar, coating heavily, and place on a lined sheet.
5. Bake 10-12 minutes, until the tops crack and the edges are set.
6. Cool on the tray 5 minutes before transferring to a rack.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 1 week.

Allergens: Contains wheat and egg.

White Chocolate Macadamia Cookies

A buttery drop cookie studded with white chocolate chips and toasted macadamia nuts.

PREP 15 MIN, PLUS 30 MIN CHILLING • BAKE 10-12 MIN • BAKING SHEET • 350F/175C • 24 COOKIES

- 2 1/4 cups (280g) all-purpose flour
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 3/4 cup (150g) granulated sugar
- 3/4 cup (165g) packed brown sugar
- 2 large eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1 1/2 cups (255g) white chocolate chips
- 1 cup (135g) macadamia nuts, roughly chopped, lightly toasted

METHOD

1. Whisk the flour, baking soda, and salt together.
2. Beat the butter and both sugars until fluffy, add the eggs one at a time, then the vanilla.
3. Mix in the flour mixture, then fold in the white chocolate and macadamia nuts.
4. Chill 30 minutes. Heat the oven to 350F/175C.
5. Scoop 1.5-tbsp mounds onto a lined sheet, spaced 2 inches apart.
6. Bake 10-12 minutes, until the edges are golden.
7. Cool on the tray 5 minutes before transferring to a rack.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 1 week.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, dairy, and tree nuts (macadamia).

Classic Thumbprint Cookies

A buttery shortbread-style cookie with a thumb-pressed well filled with jam.

PREP 20 MIN • BAKE 12-14 MIN • BAKING SHEET • 350F/175C • 22 COOKIES

- 2 cups (250g) all-purpose flour
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup (170g) unsalted butter, softened
- 1/2 cup (100g) granulated sugar
- 2 egg yolks
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1/2 cup (160g) fruit jam, any flavor, for filling

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Beat the butter and sugar until fluffy, add the egg yolks and vanilla.
2. Mix in the flour and salt until a soft dough forms.
3. Roll 1.5-tbsp balls, place on a lined sheet, and press a deep well into the center of each with your thumb.
4. Fill each well with about 1/2 tsp jam.
5. Bake 12-14 minutes, until the edges are lightly golden.
6. Cool on the tray 5 minutes before transferring to a rack.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 1 week.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

Linzer Sandwich Cookies

A ground-almond shortbread, cut with a window cutout, sandwiched with jam and dusted with powdered sugar.

PREP 25 MIN, PLUS 1 HOUR CHILLING • BAKE 10-12 MIN • BAKING SHEET • 350F/175C • 16 SANDWICH COOKIES

- 2 cups (250g) all-purpose flour
- 1 cup (120g) finely ground almonds
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 3/4 cup (90g) powdered sugar, plus more for dusting
- 1 large egg
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 3/4 cup (240g) raspberry jam, for filling

METHOD

1. Whisk the flour, ground almonds, and salt together.
2. Beat the butter and powdered sugar until fluffy, add the egg and vanilla.
3. Mix in the flour mixture until a dough forms. Chill at least 1 hour.
4. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Roll the dough 1/4-inch thick and cut into rounds, cutting a small window out of half of them.
5. Bake 10-12 minutes, until just golden at the edges. Cool completely.
6. Spread jam on the whole cookies, dust the windowed cookies with powdered sugar, and sandwich together.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 5 days (filled cookies soften over time).

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, dairy, and almonds.

Classic Biscotti

Twice-baked for a crisp, dippable texture, studded with almonds.

PREP 20 MIN • BAKE 25 MIN FIRST BAKE, 15 MIN SECOND BAKE • BAKING SHEET • 350F/175C • 24 BISCOTTI

- 3 cups (375g) all-purpose flour
- 1 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup (150g) granulated sugar
- 3 large eggs
- 1/3 cup (75g) unsalted butter, melted and cooled
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1 cup (140g) whole almonds, roughly chopped

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Whisk the flour, baking powder, and salt together.
2. Whisk the sugar, eggs, melted butter, and vanilla together, then stir in the flour mixture and almonds to form a stiff dough.
3. Divide the dough in half and shape each half into a flat log about 3 inches wide on a lined sheet.
4. Bake 25 minutes, until firm and lightly golden. Cool 10 minutes.
5. Reduce the oven to 325F/160C. Slice the logs on a diagonal into 1/2-inch slices.
6. Lay the slices cut-side down and bake 15 more minutes, flipping halfway, until crisp and dry.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 3 weeks.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, dairy, and almonds.

Classic Pinwheel Cookies

Vanilla and chocolate dough rolled together into a spiral, sliced into swirled cookies.

PREP 25 MIN, PLUS 1 HOUR CHILLING • BAKE 10-12 MIN • BAKING SHEET • 350F/175C • 24 COOKIES

- 2 2/3 cups (335g) all-purpose flour, divided
- 1 tsp baking powder
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 1 cup (200g) granulated sugar
- 1 large egg
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 3 tbsp unsweetened cocoa powder

METHOD

1. Beat the butter and sugar until fluffy, add the egg and vanilla.
2. Mix in the flour, baking powder, and salt until a dough forms, then divide the dough in half.
3. Knead the cocoa powder into one half until evenly colored.
4. Roll each half between parchment into a rectangle of the same size. Stack the chocolate layer on the vanilla layer, then roll up tightly into a log. Chill at least 1 hour.
5. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Slice the log into 1/3-inch rounds and place on a lined sheet.
6. Bake 10-12 minutes, until the edges are just set.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 1 week.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

Classic Macarons

A delicate almond-meringue cookie, sandwiched with buttercream — exacting but rewarding.

PREP 30 MIN, PLUS 30 MIN RESTING • BAKE 14-16 MIN • BAKING SHEET • 300F/150C • 20 SANDWICH COOKIES

- 1 cup (100g) almond flour
- 1 3/4 cups (210g) powdered sugar
- 3 large egg whites, room temperature
- 1/4 cup (50g) granulated sugar
- 1 batch American Buttercream, for filling (see Decorating Handbook)

METHOD

1. Sift the almond flour and powdered sugar together, discarding any coarse bits that don't pass through.
2. Whip the egg whites to soft peaks, then gradually add the granulated sugar, whipping to stiff, glossy peaks.
3. Fold the almond flour mixture into the whipped whites in three additions, until the batter flows slowly off the spatula in a thick ribbon.
4. Pipe 1.5-inch rounds onto a lined sheet. Tap the tray firmly on the counter several times to release air bubbles.
5. Let rest uncovered 30 minutes, until a skin forms and the tops no longer feel sticky.
6. Heat the oven to 300F/150C and bake 14-16 minutes, until the shells lift cleanly off the parchment.
7. Cool completely, then sandwich pairs together with buttercream.

Storage: Refrigerate filled macarons up to 5 days; they taste best after 1 day of resting in the fridge.

Allergens: Contains egg, dairy, and almonds.

Classic Spritz Cookies

A soft, pipeable butter dough pressed through a cookie press into decorative shapes.

PREP 15 MIN • BAKE 9-11 MIN • BAKING SHEET • 375F/190C • 36 SMALL COOKIES

- 2 1/2 cups (310g) all-purpose flour
- 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 3/4 cup (150g) granulated sugar
- 1 large egg
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1/2 tsp almond extract

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 375F/190C. Beat the butter and sugar until fluffy, add the egg and both extracts.
2. Mix in the flour, baking powder, and salt until a soft, pipeable dough forms (do not chill — the dough needs to stay soft for the press).
3. Load the dough into a cookie press and press shapes directly onto an ungreased baking sheet.
4. Bake 9-11 minutes, until just set but not browned.
5. Cool on the tray 2 minutes before transferring to a rack.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 2 weeks.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, dairy, and almond.

Coconut Macaroons

Dense and chewy, held together with sweetened condensed milk rather than flour.

PREP 15 MIN • BAKE 18-20 MIN • BAKING SHEET • 325F/160C • 20 MACAROONS

- 14 oz (400g) shredded coconut
- 14 oz (396g) sweetened condensed milk
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 2 large egg whites
- 1/4 tsp salt

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 325F/160C. Mix the coconut, condensed milk, and vanilla together.
2. Whip the egg whites and salt to stiff peaks, then fold into the coconut mixture.
3. Scoop 1.5-tbsp mounds onto a lined sheet, shaping into rough pyramids.
4. Bake 18-20 minutes, until the tips are golden brown.
5. Cool completely on the tray before moving.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 1 week.

Allergens: Contains egg and dairy.

Almond Snowball Cookies

A buttery, ground-almond shortbread rolled twice in powdered sugar for a snowy coating.

PREP 15 MIN, PLUS 30 MIN CHILLING • BAKE 14-16 MIN • BAKING SHEET • 350F/175C • 24 COOKIES

- 2 cups (250g) all-purpose flour
- 1 cup (120g) finely ground almonds
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 1/2 cup (60g) powdered sugar, plus 1 cup (120g) more for rolling
- 1 tsp vanilla extract

METHOD

1. Beat the butter and 1/2 cup powdered sugar until fluffy, add the vanilla.
2. Mix in the flour, ground almonds, and salt until a soft dough forms. Chill 30 minutes.
3. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Roll 1-tbsp balls of dough and place on a lined sheet.
4. Bake 14-16 minutes, until set but not browned.
5. While still warm, roll each cookie in powdered sugar, then roll again once fully cooled.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 2 weeks.

Allergens: Contains wheat, dairy, and almonds.

Chocolate-Dipped Shortbread Fingers

The classic shortbread dough shaped into fingers and half-dipped in chocolate.

PREP 20 MIN, PLUS 30 MIN CHILLING • BAKE 16-18 MIN • BAKING SHEET • 325F/160C • 24 COOKIES

- 2 cups (250g) all-purpose flour
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 2/3 cup (80g) powdered sugar
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 6 oz (170g) semisweet chocolate, melted, for dipping

METHOD

1. Beat the butter, powdered sugar, and vanilla until smooth. Mix in the flour and salt until a dough forms.
2. Chill 30 minutes. Heat the oven to 325F/160C.
3. Shape the dough into finger shapes about 3 inches long and place on a lined sheet.
4. Bake 16-18 minutes, until the edges are just barely golden. Cool completely.
5. Dip one end of each cookie in melted chocolate and let set on parchment.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 2 weeks.

Allergens: Contains wheat and dairy.

Classic Florentine Cookies

Thin, lacy, caramelized cookies studded with almonds, finished with a chocolate underside.

PREP 20 MIN • BAKE 10-12 MIN • BAKING SHEET • 350F/175C • 20 COOKIES

- 1/2 cup (113g) unsalted butter
- 1/2 cup (100g) granulated sugar
- 1/4 cup (85g) honey
- 1/4 cup (60ml) heavy cream
- 1 1/2 cups (150g) sliced almonds
- 2 tbsp all-purpose flour
- 4 oz (113g) semisweet chocolate, melted

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Melt the butter, sugar, honey, and cream together over medium heat, stirring until the sugar dissolves.
2. Remove from heat and stir in the almonds and flour.
3. Drop 1-tbsp mounds, well spaced (they spread a lot), onto a lined sheet.
4. Bake 10-12 minutes, until deeply golden and lacy. Cool completely on the tray before moving — they're fragile while warm.
5. Spread the flat side of each cookie with melted chocolate and let set.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 1 week.

Allergens: Contains dairy and almonds.

Pistachio Cranberry Icebox Cookies

A slice-and-bake dough studded with pistachios and dried cranberries, made ahead and sliced as needed.

PREP 15 MIN, PLUS 2 HOURS CHILLING • BAKE 10-12 MIN • BAKING SHEET • 350F/175C • 28 COOKIES

- 2 1/2 cups (315g) all-purpose flour
- 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 1 cup (200g) granulated sugar
- 1 large egg
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 3/4 cup (95g) shelled pistachios, chopped
- 3/4 cup (90g) dried cranberries

METHOD

1. Beat the butter and sugar until fluffy, add the egg and vanilla.
2. Mix in the flour, baking powder, and salt, then fold in the pistachios and cranberries.
3. Shape into two logs about 2 inches wide, wrap, and chill at least 2 hours (or freeze up to 3 months).
4. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Slice the log into 1/3-inch rounds and place on a lined sheet.
5. Bake 10-12 minutes, until the edges are lightly golden.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 1 week; unbaked logs freeze well.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, dairy, and pistachios.

PART 3

Brownies

Thirteen brownies, fudgy and cakey, plain and swirled.

Classic Fudgy Brownies

Dense, rich, and glossy-topped — the benchmark fudgy brownie this chapter's other versions build on.

PREP 15 MIN • BAKE 28-30 MIN • 9X9-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 16 BROWNIES

- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter
- 2 1/4 cups (450g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (90g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 4 large eggs
- 1 tbsp vanilla extract
- 1 cup (125g) all-purpose flour

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Line a 9×9-inch pan with parchment, leaving an overhang.
2. Melt the butter, then whisk in the sugar, cocoa, and salt until smooth.
3. Whisk in the eggs one at a time, then the vanilla, beating vigorously for a minute to develop the glossy top.
4. Fold in the flour just until no streaks remain.
5. Pour into the pan and bake 28-30 minutes, until a toothpick has a few moist crumbs.
6. Cool completely before lifting out and cutting.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 5 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

Classic Cakey Brownies

A lighter, more cake-like crumb, from more flour and a touch of baking powder.

PREP 15 MIN • BAKE 24-26 MIN • 9X9-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 16 BROWNIES

- 3/4 cup (170g) unsalted butter
- 1 3/4 cups (350g) granulated sugar
- 3/4 cup (65g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 1 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 3 large eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1 1/4 cups (155g) all-purpose flour

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Line a 9×9-inch pan with parchment.
2. Melt the butter, then whisk in the sugar, cocoa, baking powder, and salt.
3. Whisk in the eggs one at a time, then the vanilla.
4. Fold in the flour just until combined.
5. Pour into the pan and bake 24-26 minutes, until a toothpick comes out with just a few crumbs.
6. Cool completely before cutting.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 5 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

Walnut Brownies

The classic fudgy base folded with toasted walnuts for crunch.

PREP 15 MIN • BAKE 28-30 MIN • 9X9-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 16 BROWNIES

- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter
- 2 1/4 cups (450g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (90g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 4 large eggs
- 1 tbsp vanilla extract
- 1 cup (125g) all-purpose flour
- 1 cup (120g) walnuts, roughly chopped, lightly toasted

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Line a 9×9-inch pan with parchment.
2. Melt the butter, then whisk in the sugar, cocoa, and salt.
3. Whisk in the eggs one at a time, then the vanilla.
4. Fold in the flour, then the walnuts.
5. Pour into the pan and bake 28-30 minutes, until a toothpick has a few moist crumbs.
6. Cool completely before cutting.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 5 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, dairy, and walnuts.

Cream Cheese Swirl Brownies

A tangy cream cheese layer swirled into the fudgy base before baking.

PREP 20 MIN • BAKE 32-35 MIN • 9X9-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 16 BROWNIES

BROWNIE BATTER

- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter
- 2 1/4 cups (450g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (90g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 4 large eggs
- 1 tbsp vanilla extract
- 1 cup (125g) all-purpose flour

CREAM CHEESE SWIRL

- 8 oz (225g) cream cheese, softened
- 1/4 cup (50g) granulated sugar
- 1 egg
- 1/2 tsp vanilla extract

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Line a 9×9-inch pan with parchment.
2. Beat the cream cheese swirl ingredients together until smooth and set aside.
3. Make the brownie batter as in the standard recipe and pour into the pan.
4. Drop spoonfuls of the cream cheese mixture over the top and swirl gently with a knife.
5. Bake 32-35 minutes, until the edges are set and the center has a slight wobble.
6. Cool completely before cutting.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 5 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

Peanut Butter Swirl Brownies

Peanut butter swirled through the fudgy base in generous ribbons.

PREP 20 MIN • BAKE 30-32 MIN • 9X9-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 16 BROWNIES

BROWNIE BATTER

- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter
- 2 1/4 cups (450g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (90g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 4 large eggs
- 1 tbsp vanilla extract
- 1 cup (125g) all-purpose flour

SWIRL

- 1/2 cup (130g) creamy peanut butter, warmed slightly

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Line a 9×9-inch pan with parchment.
2. Make the brownie batter as in the standard recipe and pour into the pan.
3. Drop spoonfuls of warmed peanut butter over the top and swirl gently with a knife.
4. Bake 30-32 minutes, until a toothpick has a few moist crumbs.
5. Cool completely before cutting.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 5 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, dairy, and peanuts.

Mint Chocolate Brownies

The fudgy base topped with a thin mint layer and a chocolate glaze.

PREP 20 MIN • BAKE 28-30 MIN • 9X9-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 16 BROWNIES

BROWNIE BATTER

- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter
- 2 1/4 cups (450g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (90g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 4 large eggs
- 1 tbsp vanilla extract
- 1 cup (125g) all-purpose flour

MINT LAYER

- 2 cups (240g) powdered sugar
- 3 tbsp unsalted butter, softened
- 2 tbsp heavy cream
- 1/2 tsp peppermint extract
- 1-2 drops green food coloring (optional)

GLAZE

- 4 oz (113g) semisweet chocolate, melted
- 2 tbsp unsalted butter

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Bake the brownie batter as in the standard recipe. Cool completely.
2. Beat the mint layer ingredients together until smooth and spread over the cooled brownies. Chill 20 minutes.
3. Melt the glaze ingredients together and spread over the mint layer.
4. Chill until the glaze sets, about 20 minutes, before cutting.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 5 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

Salted Caramel Brownies

A pool of salted caramel baked into the center of the fudgy base.

PREP 20 MIN • BAKE 30-32 MIN • 9X9-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 16 BROWNIES

BROWNIE BATTER

- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter
- 2 1/4 cups (450g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (90g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 4 large eggs
- 1 tbsp vanilla extract
- 1 cup (125g) all-purpose flour

CARAMEL LAYER

- 1/2 cup prepared salted caramel sauce (see Cheesecake chapter)
- Flaky sea salt, for garnish

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Pour half the brownie batter into the pan.
2. Drizzle the caramel sauce evenly over the batter, then top with the remaining batter.
3. Bake 30-32 minutes, until a toothpick has a few moist crumbs (it may catch caramel — that's expected).
4. Cool completely, then sprinkle with flaky salt before cutting.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 5 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

Raspberry Swirl Brownies

A tart raspberry puree swirled through the fudgy base for a fruity contrast.

PREP 20 MIN • BAKE 30-32 MIN • 9X9-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 16 BROWNIES

BROWNIE BATTER

- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter
- 2 1/4 cups (450g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (90g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 4 large eggs
- 1 tbsp vanilla extract
- 1 cup (125g) all-purpose flour

RASPBERRY SWIRL

- 1 cup (125g) raspberries, fresh or frozen
- 3 tbsp granulated sugar
- 1 tsp cornstarch mixed with 1 tsp water

METHOD

1. Cook the raspberries and sugar over medium heat until softened, stir in the cornstarch slurry, and simmer until thickened. Strain seeds if desired and cool.
2. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Pour the brownie batter into the pan.
3. Drop spoonfuls of raspberry sauce over the top and swirl with a knife.
4. Bake 30-32 minutes, until a toothpick has a few moist crumbs.
5. Cool completely before cutting.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 5 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

Espresso Brownies

Espresso powder deepens the chocolate flavor without tasting distinctly of coffee.

PREP 15 MIN • BAKE 28-30 MIN • 9X9-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 16 BROWNIES

- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter
- 2 1/4 cups (450g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (90g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 1 tbsp espresso powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 4 large eggs
- 1 tbsp vanilla extract
- 1 cup (125g) all-purpose flour

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Line a 9×9-inch pan with parchment.
2. Melt the butter, then whisk in the sugar, cocoa, espresso powder, and salt.
3. Whisk in the eggs one at a time, then the vanilla.
4. Fold in the flour just until combined.
5. Pour into the pan and bake 28-30 minutes, until a toothpick has a few moist crumbs.
6. Cool completely before cutting.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 5 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

Rocky Road Brownies

The fudgy base topped with marshmallows, chocolate chips, and chopped nuts in the last few minutes of baking.

PREP 20 MIN • BAKE 26-28 MIN • 9X9-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 16 BROWNIES

BROWNIE BATTER

- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter
- 2 1/4 cups (450g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (90g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 4 large eggs
- 1 tbsp vanilla extract
- 1 cup (125g) all-purpose flour

TOPPING

- 1 1/2 cups (75g) mini marshmallows
- 1/2 cup (85g) chocolate chips
- 1/2 cup (60g) walnuts or pecans, chopped

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Bake the brownie batter 20 minutes.
2. Scatter the marshmallows, chocolate chips, and nuts over the top.
3. Return to the oven for 6-8 more minutes, until the marshmallows are puffed and golden.
4. Cool completely before cutting (the topping is sticky while warm).

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 4 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, dairy, and tree nuts.

Cheesecake Swirl Brownies

The fudgy base swirled with a plain cheesecake layer for a marbled look and tangy contrast.

PREP 20 MIN • BAKE 32-34 MIN • 9X9-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 16 BROWNIES

BROWNIE BATTER

- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter
- 2 1/4 cups (450g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (90g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 4 large eggs
- 1 tbsp vanilla extract
- 1 cup (125g) all-purpose flour

CHEESECAKE SWIRL

- 8 oz (225g) cream cheese, softened
- 1/3 cup (65g) granulated sugar
- 1 egg
- 1/2 tsp vanilla extract

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Beat the cheesecake swirl ingredients until smooth.
2. Make the brownie batter as in the standard recipe and pour into a lined 9×9-inch pan.
3. Drop spoonfuls of the cheesecake mixture over the top and swirl with a knife.
4. Bake 32-34 minutes, until the edges are set and the center has a slight wobble.
5. Cool completely, then chill 1 hour before cutting for the cleanest slices.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 5 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

Nutella Swirl Brownies

A hazelnut-chocolate spread swirled generously through the fudgy base.

PREP 15 MIN • BAKE 28-30 MIN • 9X9-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 16 BROWNIES

BROWNIE BATTER

- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter
- 2 1/4 cups (450g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (90g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 4 large eggs
- 1 tbsp vanilla extract
- 1 cup (125g) all-purpose flour

SWIRL

- 1/2 cup (135g) chocolate-hazelnut spread, warmed slightly

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Make the brownie batter as in the standard recipe and pour into a lined 9×9-inch pan.
2. Drop spoonfuls of the warmed chocolate-hazelnut spread over the top and swirl with a knife.
3. Bake 28-30 minutes, until a toothpick has a few moist crumbs.
4. Cool completely before cutting.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 5 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, dairy, and hazelnuts.

Triple Chocolate Chunk Brownies

The fudgy base studded with dark, milk, and white chocolate chunks for three distinct textures.

PREP 15 MIN • BAKE 28-30 MIN • 9X9-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 16 BROWNIES

- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter
- 2 1/4 cups (450g) granulated sugar
- 1 cup (90g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 4 large eggs
- 1 tbsp vanilla extract
- 1 cup (125g) all-purpose flour
- 1/3 cup (55g) dark chocolate chunks
- 1/3 cup (55g) milk chocolate chunks
- 1/3 cup (55g) white chocolate chunks

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Melt the butter, then whisk in the sugar, cocoa, and salt.
2. Whisk in the eggs one at a time, then the vanilla.
3. Fold in the flour, then all three chocolate chunks, reserving a few of each to scatter on top.
4. Pour into a lined 9×9-inch pan, scatter the reserved chunks over the top, and bake 28-30 minutes.
5. Cool completely before cutting.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 5 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

PART 4

Blondies & Dessert Bars

Fifteen layered bars and blondies, from classic lemon bars to a no-bake peanut butter chocolate bar.

Classic Blondies

A brown-sugar, brown-butter cousin to the brownie, with a chewy, caramel-toned crumb.

PREP 15 MIN • BAKE 24-26 MIN • 9X9-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 16 BLONDIES

- 3/4 cup (170g) unsalted butter, melted
- 1 1/2 cups (330g) packed brown sugar
- 2 large eggs
- 2 tsp vanilla extract
- 2 cups (250g) all-purpose flour
- 1 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 cup (170g) chocolate chips

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Line a 9×9-inch pan with parchment.
2. Whisk the melted butter and brown sugar together, then whisk in the eggs and vanilla.
3. Fold in the flour, baking powder, and salt just until combined, then fold in the chocolate chips.
4. Pour into the pan and bake 24-26 minutes, until the edges are golden and a toothpick has a few moist crumbs.
5. Cool completely before cutting.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 5 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

Brown Butter Pecan Blondies

Browned butter adds a nutty depth, paired with toasted pecans.

PREP 20 MIN • BAKE 26-28 MIN • 9X9-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 16 BLONDIES

- 3/4 cup (170g) unsalted butter, browned and cooled slightly
- 1 1/2 cups (330g) packed brown sugar
- 2 large eggs
- 2 tsp vanilla extract
- 2 cups (250g) all-purpose flour
- 1 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 cup (110g) pecans, chopped, lightly toasted

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Brown the butter in a saucepan until nutty and golden-flecked; cool slightly.
2. Whisk the browned butter and brown sugar together, then whisk in the eggs and vanilla.
3. Fold in the flour, baking powder, and salt, then the pecans.
4. Pour into a lined 9×9-inch pan and bake 26-28 minutes, until a toothpick has a few moist crumbs.
5. Cool completely before cutting.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 5 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, dairy, and pecans.

Classic Lemon Bars

A buttery shortbread crust under a tangy, set lemon curd filling, dusted with powdered sugar.

PREP 20 MIN • BAKE 15 MIN CRUST, 20 MIN FILLING • 9X9-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 16 BARS

CRUST

- 1 1/4 cups (155g) all-purpose flour
- 1/4 cup (30g) powdered sugar
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1/2 cup (113g) unsalted butter, cold, cubed

FILLING

- 1 1/2 cups (300g) granulated sugar
- 1/4 cup (30g) all-purpose flour
- 4 large eggs
- 2/3 cup (160ml) fresh lemon juice
- Zest of 2 lemons
- Powdered sugar, for dusting

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Pulse the crust ingredients together until the mixture looks like coarse crumbs, then press into a lined 9×9-inch pan.
2. Bake the crust 15 minutes, until lightly golden.
3. Whisk the filling ingredients together and pour over the hot crust.
4. Bake 20 more minutes, until the center is just set and no longer jiggles like liquid.
5. Cool completely, then chill at least 1 hour before cutting. Dust with powdered sugar before serving.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 4 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

Classic Seven-Layer Bars

A no-mixer bar built entirely in layers over a graham crust and sweetened condensed milk.

PREP 15 MIN • BAKE 25-28 MIN • 9X13-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 24 BARS

- 1 1/2 cups (150g) graham cracker crumbs
- 1/2 cup (113g) unsalted butter, melted
- 1 1/2 cups (255g) semisweet chocolate chips
- 1 1/2 cups (255g) butterscotch chips
- 1 1/3 cups (115g) shredded coconut
- 1 cup (120g) chopped pecans
- 14 oz (396g) sweetened condensed milk

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Mix the graham crumbs and melted butter and press into a lined 9×13-inch pan.
2. Layer the chocolate chips, butterscotch chips, coconut, and pecans evenly over the crust in that order.
3. Pour the condensed milk evenly over the top.
4. Bake 25-28 minutes, until the edges are golden and bubbling.
5. Cool completely before cutting — the layers set as they cool.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 1 week.

Allergens: Contains wheat, dairy, and pecans.

Classic Pumpkin Bars

A spiced sheet cake baked as bars, frosted with cream cheese icing.

PREP 20 MIN • BAKE 25-28 MIN • 9X13-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 24 BARS

- 2 cups (250g) all-purpose flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 2 tsp ground cinnamon
- 1 cup (240ml) vegetable oil
- 1 3/4 cups (350g) granulated sugar
- 4 large eggs
- 15 oz (425g) pumpkin puree

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Whisk the flour, baking powder, baking soda, salt, and cinnamon together.
2. Whisk the oil, sugar, and eggs together, then whisk in the pumpkin puree.
3. Fold in the flour mixture just until combined.
4. Pour into a lined 9×13-inch pan and bake 25-28 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
5. Cool completely, then frost with cream cheese frosting (see Decorating Handbook) before cutting.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 4 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

Raspberry Oat Crumble Bars

An oat crumble base and topping sandwiching a layer of raspberry preserves.

PREP 20 MIN • BAKE 35-38 MIN • 9X9-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 16 BARS

- 1 1/2 cups (150g) old-fashioned rolled oats
- 1 1/2 cups (190g) all-purpose flour
- 3/4 cup (150g) packed brown sugar
- 1/2 tsp baking soda
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup (170g) unsalted butter, melted
- 1 cup (320g) raspberry preserves

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Mix the oats, flour, brown sugar, baking soda, and salt together, then stir in the melted butter until crumbly.
2. Press two-thirds of the mixture into a lined 9×9-inch pan.
3. Spread the raspberry preserves evenly over the base.
4. Scatter the remaining oat mixture over the top, pressing lightly.
5. Bake 35-38 minutes, until the top is golden.
6. Cool completely before cutting.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 5 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat and dairy.

Salted Caramel Bars

A shortbread base topped with a soft caramel layer, finished with flaky salt.

PREP 25 MIN • BAKE 18-20 MIN • 9X9-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 16 BARS

BASE

- 2 cups (250g) all-purpose flour
- 1/2 cup (60g) powdered sugar
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, cold, cubed

CARAMEL

- 1 cup (200g) granulated sugar
- 6 tbsp (85g) unsalted butter
- 1/2 cup (120ml) heavy cream, warmed
- 1 tsp flaky sea salt, plus more for garnish

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Pulse the base ingredients until crumbly, then press into a lined 9×9-inch pan.
2. Bake the base 18-20 minutes, until lightly golden. Cool slightly.
3. For the caramel, melt the sugar over medium heat until amber, then whisk in the butter, followed by the warm cream and salt.
4. Pour the hot caramel over the baked base and spread evenly.
5. Chill at least 2 hours, until firm, then sprinkle with more flaky salt and cut into bars.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 1 week.

Allergens: Contains wheat and dairy.

Classic Magic Cookie Bars

A simpler, smaller-batch relative of the seven-layer bar.

PREP 10 MIN • BAKE 25 MIN • 9X9-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 16 BARS

- 1 cup (100g) graham cracker crumbs
- 1/4 cup (55g) unsalted butter, melted
- 1 cup (170g) chocolate chips
- 1 cup (85g) shredded coconut
- 10 oz (280g) sweetened condensed milk

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Mix the graham crumbs and butter and press into a lined 9×9-inch pan.
2. Scatter the chocolate chips and coconut over the crust.
3. Pour the condensed milk evenly over the top.
4. Bake 25 minutes, until the edges are golden.
5. Cool completely before cutting.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 1 week.

Allergens: Contains wheat and dairy.

Peanut Butter Chocolate Bars

A no-bake peanut butter layer topped with melted chocolate, similar to a candy-bar texture.

PREP 20 MIN • CHILL 1 HOUR • 9X9-INCH PAN • 16 BARS

- 1 cup (260g) creamy peanut butter
- 1/2 cup (113g) unsalted butter, softened
- 1 1/2 cups (180g) powdered sugar
- 1 1/2 cups (150g) graham cracker crumbs
- 1 1/2 cups (255g) chocolate chips, melted

METHOD

1. Line a 9×9-inch pan with parchment.
2. Beat the peanut butter and butter together, then mix in the powdered sugar and graham crumbs until a thick, cohesive mixture forms.
3. Press firmly and evenly into the pan.
4. Pour the melted chocolate over the top and spread evenly.
5. Chill at least 1 hour, until the chocolate is firm, before cutting.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 1 week.

Allergens: Contains wheat, dairy, and peanuts.

Apple Crumble Bars

A shortbread base and crumble topping sandwiching a spiced apple filling.

PREP 25 MIN • BAKE 40-45 MIN • 9X9-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 16 BARS

BASE & CRUMBLE

- 2 1/2 cups (315g) all-purpose flour
- 3/4 cup (150g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, cold, cubed
- 1 large egg

APPLE FILLING

- 3 apples, peeled and diced
- 3 tbsp granulated sugar
- 1 tsp ground cinnamon
- 1 tbsp cornstarch
- 1 tbsp lemon juice

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Pulse the base ingredients together with the egg until crumbly, then press two-thirds into a lined 9×9-inch pan. Reserve the rest for the topping.
2. Toss the apple filling ingredients together and spread over the base.
3. Crumble the reserved dough over the top.
4. Bake 40-45 minutes, until the top is golden and the filling bubbles at the edges.
5. Cool completely before cutting.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 4 days, or refrigerate up to 1 week.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

S'mores Bars

A graham-cracker base and crumble sandwiching a chocolate-marshmallow layer.

PREP 20 MIN • BAKE 25-28 MIN • 9X9-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 16 BARS

- 1 1/2 cups (190g) all-purpose flour
- 1 cup (100g) graham cracker crumbs
- 1 cup (220g) packed brown sugar
- 1/2 tsp baking soda
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup (170g) unsalted butter, melted
- 1 1/2 cups (255g) chocolate chips
- 2 cups (100g) mini marshmallows

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Mix the flour, graham crumbs, brown sugar, baking soda, and salt, then stir in the melted butter until crumbly.
2. Press two-thirds of the mixture into a lined 9×9-inch pan.
3. Scatter the chocolate chips over the base, then bake 10 minutes.
4. Scatter the marshmallows over the top, then crumble the remaining oat mixture over everything.
5. Bake 15-18 more minutes, until the marshmallows are golden and the top is set.
6. Cool completely before cutting.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 4 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat and dairy.

Key Lime Bars

The lemon bar technique applied to key lime (or regular lime) juice, for a tart, tropical twist.

PREP 20 MIN • BAKE 15 MIN CRUST, 15 MIN FILLING • 9X9-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 16 BARS

CRUST

- 1 1/4 cups (125g) graham cracker crumbs
- 1/4 cup (50g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (113g) unsalted butter, melted

FILLING

- 14 oz (396g) sweetened condensed milk
- 4 egg yolks
- 1/2 cup (120ml) fresh key lime or lime juice
- Zest of 2 limes

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Mix the crust ingredients and press into a lined 9×9-inch pan.
2. Bake the crust 15 minutes, until lightly golden.
3. Whisk the condensed milk, egg yolks, lime juice, and zest together until smooth.
4. Pour over the hot crust and bake 15 minutes, until just set at the edges with a slight wobble in the center.
5. Cool completely, then chill at least 2 hours before cutting.

Storage: Refrigerate up to 5 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

Date and Walnut Bars

A naturally sweet, sticky date filling sandwiched in an oat crumble, similar in method to the raspberry version.

PREP 25 MIN • BAKE 30-32 MIN • 9X9-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 16 BARS

OAT CRUMBLE

- 1 1/2 cups (150g) old-fashioned rolled oats
- 1 1/2 cups (190g) all-purpose flour
- 3/4 cup (150g) packed brown sugar
- 1/2 tsp baking soda
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup (170g) unsalted butter, melted

DATE FILLING

- 2 cups (340g) pitted dates, chopped
- 3/4 cup (180ml) water
- 1 tbsp fresh lemon juice
- 1/2 cup (60g) walnuts, chopped

METHOD

1. Simmer the dates and water over medium heat, stirring and mashing, until thick and jam-like, about 10 minutes. Stir in the lemon juice and walnuts; cool slightly.
2. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Mix the oat crumble ingredients together until crumbly.
3. Press two-thirds of the crumble into a lined 9×9-inch pan.
4. Spread the date filling evenly over the base, then scatter the remaining crumble over the top.
5. Bake 30-32 minutes, until golden. Cool completely before cutting.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 1 week.

Allergens: Contains wheat, dairy, and walnuts.

Congo Bars

A sheet-pan blondie studded with chocolate chips and coconut, sized for a crowd.

PREP 15 MIN • BAKE 24-26 MIN • 9X13-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 24 BARS

- 2 2/3 cups (335g) all-purpose flour
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1 tsp salt
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, melted
- 2 cups (440g) packed brown sugar
- 3 large eggs
- 1 tbsp vanilla extract
- 1 1/2 cups (255g) chocolate chips
- 1 cup (85g) shredded coconut

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Whisk the flour, baking powder, and salt together.
2. Whisk the melted butter and brown sugar together, then whisk in the eggs and vanilla.
3. Fold in the flour mixture, then the chocolate chips and coconut.
4. Spread into a lined 9×13-inch pan and bake 24-26 minutes, until a toothpick has a few moist crumbs.
5. Cool completely before cutting.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 5 days.

Allergens: Contains wheat, egg, and dairy.

Toffee Crunch Bars

A shortbread-style base topped with toffee bits and a chocolate drizzle, baked together in one pan.

PREP 15 MIN • BAKE 22-24 MIN • 9X9-INCH PAN • 350F/175C • 16 BARS

- 2 cups (250g) all-purpose flour
- 1/2 cup (100g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (110g) packed brown sugar
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1 cup (226g) unsalted butter, softened
- 1 cup (170g) toffee bits
- 1/2 cup (85g) chocolate chips, melted, for drizzling

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F/175C. Beat the butter and both sugars until fluffy.
2. Mix in the flour and salt until a soft dough forms, then fold in two-thirds of the toffee bits.
3. Press into a lined 9×9-inch pan and scatter the remaining toffee bits over the top.
4. Bake 22-24 minutes, until golden at the edges.
5. Cool completely, then drizzle with melted chocolate before cutting.

Storage: Store airtight at room temperature up to 1 week.

Allergens: Contains wheat and dairy.

Recipe Index

Classic Chocolate Chip Cookies
Classic Sugar Cookies
Classic Peanut Butter Cookies
Classic Oatmeal Raisin Cookies
Oatmeal Chocolate Chip Cookies
Classic Snickerdoodles
Classic Shortbread Cookies
Classic Molasses Cookies
Classic Gingerbread Cookies
Classic Chocolate Crinkle Cookies

White Chocolate Macadamia Cookies

Classic Thumbprint Cookies

Linzer Sandwich Cookies

Classic Biscotti

Classic Pinwheel Cookies

Classic Macarons

Classic Spritz Cookies

Coconut Macaroons

Almond Snowball Cookies

Chocolate-Dipped Shortbread Fingers

Classic Florentine Cookies

Pistachio Cranberry Icebox Cookies

Classic Fudgy Brownies

Classic Cakey Brownies

Walnut Brownies

Cream Cheese Swirl Brownies

Peanut Butter Swirl Brownies

Mint Chocolate Brownies

Salted Caramel Brownies

Raspberry Swirl Brownies

Espresso Brownies

Rocky Road Brownies

Cheesecake Swirl Brownies

Nutella Swirl Brownies

Triple Chocolate Chunk Brownies

Classic Blondies

Brown Butter Pecan Blondies

Classic Lemon Bars

Classic Seven-Layer Bars

Classic Pumpkin Bars

Raspberry Oat Crumble Bars

Salted Caramel Bars

Classic Magic Cookie Bars

Peanut Butter Chocolate Bars

Apple Crumble Bars

S'mores Bars

Key Lime Bars

Date and Walnut Bars

Congo Bars

Toffee Crunch Bars